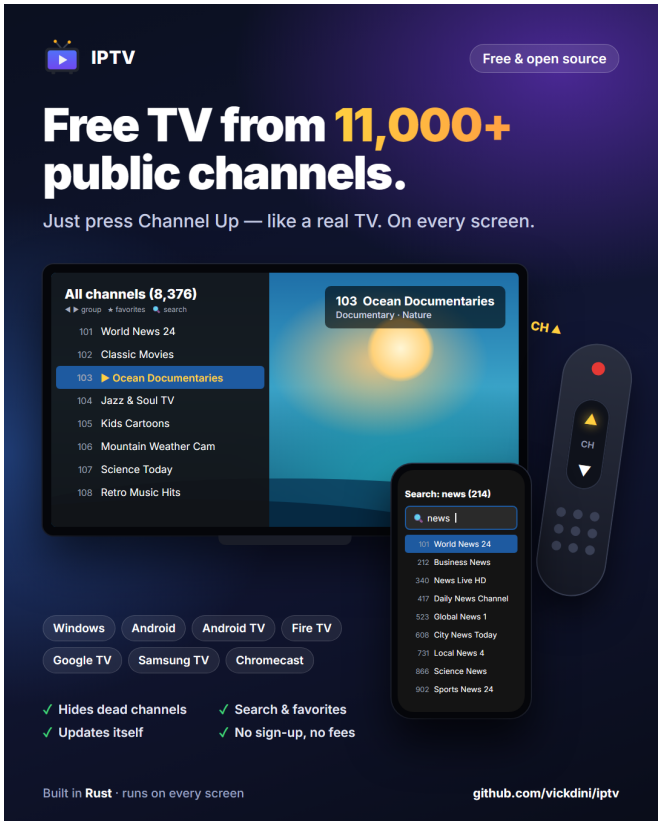
IPTV

Quick Start Guide

Watch free TV channels and zap like a TV



Windows • macOS • Linux • Android • Android TV & Fire TV • Chromecast • Samsung TV

Version 0.9 • `https://github.com/vickdini/iptv`

Contents

1 About IPTV **2**

2 Windows **2**

2.1 Install . . . 2

2.2 Keys . . . 2

2.3 The channel list . . . 3

2.4 Countries and languages . . . 3

2.5 Audio language and subtitles . . . 3

2.6 Updates . . . 3

3 macOS **3**

3.1 Install . . . 3

3.2 First launch . . . 4

3.3 Using it . . . 4

4 Linux **4**

4.1 Install . . . 4

4.2 Using it . . . 4

5 Android phones and tablets **4**

5.1 Install . . . 4

5.2 Gestures . . . 4

5.3 Two channels at once . . . 5

5.4 Picture-in-picture . . . 5

5.5 The channel list . . . 5

5.6 Updates . . . 5

6 Android TV, Google TV and Fire TV **5**

6.1 Remote control . . . 6

7 Chromecast **6**

8 Samsung smart TVs **6**

8.1 Install . . . 6

8.2 Remote control . . . 7

9 Phone remote **7**

10 Troubleshooting **7**

1 About IPTV

IPTV plays the free, publicly listed TV channels collected by the *iptv-org* project (more than 10 000 of them) and lets you switch between them like on a television: channel up and down, channel numbers, favorites and groups such as News, Movies or Sports.

- **Always up to date.** The channel list is refreshed each time IPTV starts, and the app updates itself when a new version is out.
- **Only channels that work.** Offline channels are hidden automatically, so zapping never stops on a black screen.
- **Find channels quickly.** Search by name, or show only the countries and languages you are interested in.
- **Your language.** On channels that broadcast it, choose the audio language and turn on subtitles.
- **Phone remote.** Control the TV or computer from your phone's browser (Section 9).

Everything you need is included in each download: there is nothing else to install. All downloads are on the release page:

`https://github.com/vickdini/iptv/releases/latest`

Disclaimer. IPTV doesn't host or provide any video: it only loads a publicly available playlist published by the iptv-org project. Only watch what you are legally allowed to watch in your country.

2 Windows

2.1 Install

1. Download `IPTV-Setup-<version>.exe` from the release page and open it.
2. If Windows says *Windows protected your PC*, click *More info* and then *Run anyway*.
3. Follow the installer. It needs no administrator rights, and adds a Start-menu shortcut (and a desktop icon, if you want one).

IPTV opens maximized and starts playing straight away. To remove it, use *Settings* → *Apps*.

2.2 Keys

These keys work on every computer: Windows, macOS and Linux.

Key	What it does
↑ ↓, PgUp PgDn, mouse wheel	next / previous channel
0–9, then wait or Enter	go to a channel number
Backspace	back to the previous channel
← →, m	volume down / up, mute
I, Tab or right-click	open / close the channel list
/ or Ctrl+F	search channels by name
c	choose countries and languages

g / G	next / previous group (News, Movies…)
s / S	add or remove a favorite / zap through favorites only
a / t	next audio language / next subtitles (and off)
r	phone remote: show the QR code
i	channel information
f, double-click	full screen (Esc leaves it)
p	picture-in-picture: a second channel, small, in the bottom-right corner
[/]	the small picture's previous / next channel
x, click on the small picture	swap the two channels
Space	pause
h, ? or F1	help on screen
q	quit

2.3 The channel list

Press i to open a scrollable list of channels on the left; the video keeps playing beside it. Scroll with the mouse wheel and click a channel to watch it. Start typing (or press /) to search: accents and capital letters don't matter. Esc closes the list.

2.4 Countries and languages

Press c, type to find a country or language, and press Enter to tick it; Tab switches between the two lists. From then on IPTV shows only channels from the ticked countries or in the ticked languages, until you clear the choice (Del, or the *Clear all* row).

2.5 Audio language and subtitles

When a channel offers more than one audio language or subtitles, a note at the bottom of the screen says so. Press a for the next audio language and t for the next subtitles (and finally *off*). IPTV remembers the language and uses it on every other channel that offers it.

2.6 Updates

Each time it starts, IPTV checks for a new version. If there is one, it installs it silently and restarts on its own after a few seconds.

3 macOS

3.1 Install

1. Find out which chip your Mac has: *Apple menu* → *About This Mac*.
2. Download the matching disk image from the release page:
   - Apple silicon (M1, M2, M3, M4…): `IPTV-<version>-macOS-arm64.dmg`
   - Intel: `IPTV-<version>-macOS-x86_64.dmg`
3. Open it and drag **IPTV** onto **Applications**.

3.2 First launch

IPTV is not notarized by Apple, so the first time macOS refuses to open it. This is needed only once:

1. Open IPTV from Applications. When macOS says it can't be opened, click *Done*.
2. Open *System Settings* → *Privacy & Security*, scroll down to *"IPTV" was blocked…* and click *Open Anyway*, then confirm.

3.3 Using it

IPTV uses the same keys as on Windows (Section 2.2). In the Dock it appears as **IPTV** while a channel is playing.

Tip. Keep IPTV in the Applications folder: started from the disk image or from Downloads, macOS runs it from a read-only copy and it can't update itself.

4 Linux

4.1 Install

Download `IPTV-<version>-x86_64.AppImage` from the release page. It is a single file with everything included. Make it executable and run it:

```
chmod +x IPTV-*-x86_64.AppImage
./IPTV-*-x86_64.AppImage
```

In a file manager you can instead open *Properties* → *Permissions*, tick *Allow executing as a program*, and double-click it.

It runs on 64-bit PCs with a Linux from 2022 or later (Ubuntu 22.04, Debian 12, Fedora 36, Linux Mint 21 and newer).

Tip. Tools such as *Gear Lever* or *AppImageLauncher* add IPTV to the applications menu. If the AppImage complains that FUSE is missing, start it with `--appimage-extract-and-run`.

4.2 Using it

IPTV uses the same keys as on Windows (Section 2.2). It updates itself by replacing the AppImage file, so keep it in a folder you can write to (your home folder, for example).

5 Android phones and tablets

5.1 Install

1. On the phone, download `IPTV-<version>.apk` from the release page and open it.
2. Android asks once to allow installing apps from your browser or file manager: allow it, then tap *Install*.
3. IPTV isn't on Google Play, so Play Protect may warn about an unknown developer: choose *Install anyway*.

5.2 Gestures

Gesture	What it does

swipe up / down	next / previous channel
tap	open / close the channel list
double-tap	back to the previous channel
long-press	channel information

5.3 Two channels at once

Hold the phone or tablet upright and the screen splits in two, one channel above the other. Tap a half to hear it: a thin blue border marks it, and the channel list and the phone remote act on it. Swipe a half up or down to change its channel. Turn the device sideways again for a single channel.

5.4 Picture-in-picture

Leave the app while watching (Home button, or swipe up from the bottom): the channel keeps playing in a small window over your other apps, with buttons to change channel. Tap the window to return to IPTV, or drag it away to close it. Needs Android 8 or later.

5.5 The channel list

Tap the screen to open it. Tap a channel to watch it, long-press it to add or remove a favorite. The buttons at the top:

- **Search** box: type part of a channel's name.
- ◄ ► arrows and ★: previous / next group, favorites only.
- **Globe**: choose countries and languages.
- **Subtitles** (only on channels that offer a choice): audio language and subtitles.
- **Cast**: play on a Chromecast (Section 7).
- **Exit**: closes IPTV (and stops casting).

5.6 Updates

IPTV checks for a new version when it starts. The first time, Android asks to allow IPTV to install apps; after that, updates install with at most one confirmation.

6 Android TV, Google TV and Fire TV

The same app runs on TV devices and is controlled with the remote. TV stores don't offer it, so it is installed once with the free *Downloader* app:

- **Fire TV / Fire TV Stick:** install *Downloader* from the Amazon store. Then open *Settings* → *My Fire TV* → *Developer options* → *Install unknown apps* and turn on Downloader.
- **Google TV, Chromecast with Google TV, Android TV:** install *Downloader* from the Play Store and allow it under *Settings* → *Apps* → *Security & restrictions* → *Unknown sources*.

In Downloader, enter

`https://github.com/vickdini/iptv/releases/latest`

then download `IPTV-<version>.apk` and install it. IPTV then appears among the TV's apps.

6.1 Remote control

Button	What it does
Up / Down, Channel +/−, Fast-forward / Rewind	next / previous channel
OK, Play/Pause, Menu	open / close the channel list
Left / Right	previous / next group
0–9 (if your remote has them)	go to a channel number
Back	close the list
Info	channel information
Audio / CC keys (if any)	next audio language / subtitles

In the channel list, press Up on the first channel to reach the search box. The buttons at the top of the list choose countries and languages, audio and subtitles, and open the phone remote.

Tip. Most of these remotes have no number keys: the phone remote (Section 9) is the quickest way to pick a channel.

7 Chromecast

Older Chromecasts (the plain dongle without a remote) can't install apps. Cast to them from the Android app instead:

1. Make sure the phone and the Chromecast are on the same Wi-Fi.
2. Open the channel list in IPTV, tap the **Cast** button, and choose your Chromecast.
3. Zap on the phone as usual: the TV follows.

Some channels can't be cast because their servers don't allow it; IPTV skips them automatically.

8 Samsung smart TVs

IPTV works on Samsung TVs from 2019 on. Samsung only lets you install apps that aren't in its store from a computer, with the TV in *Developer Mode*. The setup is done once, on a Windows PC on the same Wi-Fi as the TV.

8.1 Install

1. On the PC, install the *Tizen Studio* command-line tools from `https://developer.tizen.org`. In its Package Manager, install *Samsung Certificate Extension* and *TV Extensions Tools* (*Extension SDK* tab).
2. On the TV, open *Apps* and type 1 2 3 4 5 with the remote. Switch *Developer mode* on, enter the PC's IP address, and restart the TV.
3. Download `IPTV-Samsung-TV-<version>.zip` from the release page and unzip it.
4. Find the TV's IP address (*Settings* → *General* → *Network* → *Network Status*) and run, in the unzipped folder:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install-on-tv.ps1 -TvIp 192.168.1.4
```

The first time, it explains how to create the free Samsung certificate (sign in with a Samsung account). Run it again afterwards: it installs IPTV, which then appears in the TV's Apps.

After this, IPTV updates itself: no need to repeat the setup for new versions.

8.2 Remote control

Button	What it does
Up / Down, CH + / CH −	next / previous channel
0–9	go to a channel number
OK	channel list (in the list: watch the selected channel)
Left / Right	previous / next group
PRE-CH	back to the previous channel
INFO	channel information
🔴 **Red**	add or remove a favorite
🟢 **Green**	favorites only
🟡 **Yellow**	audio language and subtitles menu
🟡 **Yellow** in the list	choose countries and languages
🔵 **Blue**	search channels by name
Back	close the list, or leave IPTV

The phone remote (Section 9) isn't available on Samsung TVs yet. The free *SmartThings* app works as a phone remote for the basic buttons.

9 Phone remote

Control IPTV from your phone, Android or iPhone, with nothing to install. You can browse and search every channel and tap one to watch it, and the remote also has favorites, channel up / down, volume, audio language and subtitles. It works with IPTV on a computer and on Android TV, Google TV and Fire TV.

1. On a computer press r. On Android TV, Google TV or Fire TV, open the channel list and choose the **phone remote** button. A QR code appears.
2. Scan it with your phone's camera. The phone must be on the same Wi-Fi. Without a camera, open the address shown on screen in the phone's browser and type the PIN.
3. The remote opens in the phone's browser. Add it to your home screen or bookmark it: from now on it connects by itself whenever IPTV is running.

The first time, Windows (and macOS, if its firewall is on) asks whether IPTV may use the network: allow it on **private** networks, otherwise phones can't connect. Only phones that know the PIN can control IPTV.

10 Troubleshooting

A channel doesn't play.
Many free channels go offline or only work in some countries. IPTV hides them and moves on by itself; just change channel.

The list looks shorter than before.
Check whether countries or languages are chosen (C on a computer, the globe button on Android, ● **Yellow** in the list on Samsung TVs) and clear them.

The phone remote doesn't connect.
Make sure the phone is on the same Wi-Fi (not mobile data), and that the computer's firewall allows IPTV on private networks.

Subtitles are listed but nothing appears.
Some channels announce subtitles they don't actually send. Nothing is wrong with IPTV.

Something else?
Report it at `https://github.com/vickdini/iptv/issues`.

IPTV is free software under the GNU General Public License, version 3 or later. Its source code is at `https://github.com/vickdini/iptv`.